

Application for Graduate Network Engineer

Dear Telent Early Careers Team,

I am applying for the Graduate Network Engineer role in Farnborough because Telent works on infrastructure that people depend on continuously rather than occasionally. Keeping the UK's critical digital infrastructure running is a job where a misconfigured change is felt immediately by real users, and that is the kind of environment I want to learn in. I am available for the September 2027 intake and ready to work towards IET accreditation through the rotations your two-year programme offers.

My academic background is an MSc in Information Security from Royal Holloway, awarded with Merit, with Network Security, Critical Infrastructure Security and Secure Business Architectures among the modules, preceded by a BCA covering Python, Java, JavaScript, C++, MySQL and AI. I hold CompTIA Security+ and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity. For a network engineering team this matters in a specific way: I understand not only how traffic and services are meant to be configured, but why segmentation, access control and monitoring exist in the first place, which makes me quicker to recognise when a design choice creates a risk rather than only when it creates an outage.

I have applied that to real systems rather than only to coursework. I developed a local tool that maps Windows error codes to their common causes, and used it to investigate intermittent server freezes and crashes, tracing them to errors associated with missing or corrupted DLLs and informing the corrective action taken. I also developed a phishing-analysis prototype in Python with the Gmail API and an LLM, mapping findings to MITRE ATT&CK and keeping every result for a human to validate before anything is acted on. Diagnose from evidence, fix the cause rather than the symptom, document it so the next person does not repeat the work - that is the loop the troubleshooting and documentation side of your role runs on.

In my current IT support role I am the first point of contact for 15 colleagues across 15 to 20 devices, troubleshooting access and system problems, monitoring server health and maintaining network and website-access controls, while handling four to five access requests a day through on-premises Active Directory. That has given me a practical grounding in the unglamorous half of operational support: checking what a user actually needs, making a change without breaking the person next to them, and recording what was done. At Co-op, as Person in Charge, I coordinate seven or eight colleagues per shift and explain control requirements to people with no particular interest in them, which taught me to make a technical point land with a non-technical audience - useful in a business that works alongside customers and technology partners.

What attracts me to Telent specifically is the breadth of the graduate programme: six-month rotations across departments, exposure to cloud platforms, automation and security alongside networking, and a mentorship structure rather than being left to work it out alone. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background could contribute to your engineering teams.

Kind regards,

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